

HireGuard

CONTRACT RISK, TRIAGED.

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The Story & Vision

~5

Employees the day I joined



~60

Employees today

12x

Growth in headcount – ensuring contracts are up to date weren't always prioritized.



The job lands with operators, not lawyers

In most startups, legal-adjacent risk lands with CFOs, COOs, and HR leads. They didn't ask for it. They're not lawyers. But the budget question still falls on them: which agreements actually deserve legal spend right now?

They don't know what they don't know.

The current workflow

Store

Agreements live in Google Drive, sometimes scattered across folders

Refresh

HR consultant updates templates – often only when something prompts it

Customize

Team adjusts language for culture, operations, and IP / conflict expectations

Reuse

Template becomes the default for every new hire going forward

Escalate

Lawyers pulled in selectively – usually after a dispute or exit. Limited engagement.





What should we fix first?



What HireGuard Aims to Do

Drop in your open agreements.
Get back a prioritized risk view.
HireGuard does three things:

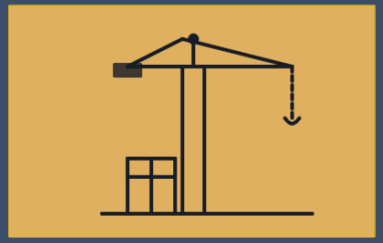
1. Ranks contracts by risk
2. Flags Alberta-specific issues
3. And it prepares focused questions for counsel — directing legal spend to what matters first.



The Business Need

We went to the source

4 conversations. 4 industries. 1 consistent pattern.



Construction



Healthcare Software



Consulting



Manufacturing

What we heard

"We spent $25K on a commission dispute because our contract didn't clearly define payouts on departure. It conflicted with employment standards."

— HR & Recruiting President

"We had a NDA and an employment agreement both reviewed separately. In hindsight, they still contained conflicting clauses."

— Tech Founder (scaling to 100 employees)

"We don't have employment contracts — it's handshake deals. I know it's a risk. We've already had issues with overtime expectations."

— Construction Company President

Common thread: the risk is real — and legal fees are the barrier to action.

Alternatives to solve the problem



Generic AI

Being used frequently - biggest “competition”

The Opportunity!



Lawyers

Avoided due to expense and time.

The learning journey…

We needed to differentiate our product further!

Employment Law Professional Opinion

"In practice, general-purpose AI tools like ChatGPT and Gemini frequently hallucinate when applied to real employment law questions. They confidently cite case names that don't exist, misattribute holdings from real decisions, and invent section numbers from statutes. I've reviewed AI-generated contract summaries that cited binding Alberta authority that turned out to be completely fabricated — not paraphrased, not mischaracterized, simply invented. These tools can be useful for drafting support and high-level awareness, but they should never be trusted to identify specific legal risks in a live employment agreement without a human expert verifying every citation."

— Based on practitioner observations in Alberta employment litigation and contract review

General-purpose AI hallucinates legal citations and oversimplifies jurisdiction-specific risk.

Three things AI alone can't give you

01

Oversimplification

What should be in an agreement?

General AI doesn't know what a comprehensive Alberta employment agreement looks like. We do — because our team includes expert HR practitioners. HireGuard evaluates contracts against what should be there, not just what is there.

02

Hallucinations

Real law, cited correctly

ChatGPT invents statutes. Gemini cites the wrong case. HireGuard forces every flag back to the actual Alberta Employment Standards Code and verified CanLII case law — citations come from code, not the model.

03

Multi-LLM

See the gap for yourself

We run the same contract through GPT-4o, Gemini, and Claude and show you the outputs side by side against HireGuard's structured analysis. You can see exactly where raw AI falls short — and why that matters when the stakes are legal.

The middle ground

Template Providers

LawDepot
LegalZoom
goHeather

These solve the drafting problem, but not the audit problem. goHeather has expanded into AI contract review and is the closest direct competitor.

Legal AI Platforms

Spellbook
LegalOn
LegalSifter

Aimed at lawyers and in-house legal teams, not HR or general managers. Pricing $99–$350/user/month.
Even these tools lack organizational context, playbook enforcement, and repeatability.

Why this is worth building

Clear user

CFOs, COOs, and HR leads already managing legal-adjacent risk

Clear pain

Contracts age, templates multiply, and routine legal review is expensive

Clear wedge

Start with Alberta employment agreements, then expand by province

Buildable MVP

A working product deliverable within the class timeline that actually creates value

How it Works?

Export as PDF



PDF Report

One click exports the full analysis as a branded PDF — risk score, category breakdown, all red flags with CanLII citations, lawyer questions, and scoring methodology.



Lawyer Prep

The PDF includes auto-generated lawyer questions scoped to your contract's specific issues. Arrive at your $400/hr appointment prepared — not starting from scratch.

Demo Video



How we Built it?

Our Process

Claude + ChatGPT PRDs

One traditional PRD, One specced for technical architecture

Claude UI drafting

Used claude to help us draft theoretical UI

API's

Sourced API keys from openai and gemini to call on LLMs in algorithm

Replit Agent

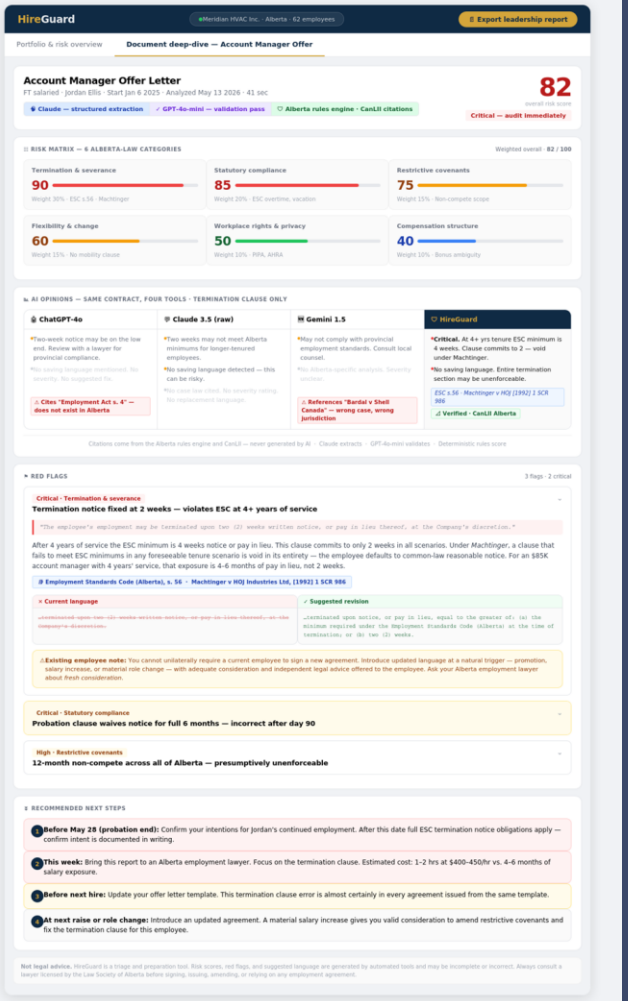
PRDs and prompt into replit. Then iterative fixes afterwards

CanLII URL searches for citations

Always ties back rulings to a legal authority or precedent - built into algorithm

★ LLM extracts facts. Deterministic TypeScript rules assign scores and attach CanLII citations. Every score traces to a specific Alberta statute or case. No hallucination possible in the scoring layer.

AI Coding Tool	Replit Agent / Claude and ChatGPT for PRD review
Framework	Next.js 14 App Router + React + TypeScript — single repo, single deploy
Styling	Tailwind CSS — production-quality UI, fast with AI agent
LLM — Layer 1	Google Gemini 2.5 Flash (fallback - gemini-1.5-flash) — structured output + comparison
LLM — Layer 2	OpenAI GPT-4o-mini — comparison
Scoring	Deterministic TypeScript rules in /lib/scoring/*.ts — versioned, CanLII-sourced
Storage (demo)	In-memory + localStorage — no database needed
Hosting	Replit free tier — one-click deploy from Replit



HireGuard

Meridian HVAC Inc. · Alberta · 62 employees

Export leadership report

Portfolio & risk overview | Document deep-dive — Account Manager Offer

2	2	1	7	2
Critical — audit immediately	High — revise before next hire	Low — monitor at review	Cross-doc conflicts found	Milestones in next 30 days

AGREEMENT PORTFOLIO · 5 DOCUMENTS · CLICK ANY ROW TO DEEP-DIVE

DOCUMENT	TYPE	SCORE	HIGHEST RISK	CONFLICTS	MILESTONE	ACTION
Executive Offer Letter	Executive · FT	91	Termination & severance	⚠ 3	Non-compete expires Jun 14	Audit immediately
Account Manager Offer	FT salaried	82	Termination & severance	⚠ 2	Probation ends May 28	Audit immediately
Software Dev Agreement	FT salaried	74	Restrictive covenants	⊗ 1	Annual review Aug 1	Revise before next hire
Server Contract	PT hourly	68	Statutory compliance	⊗ 1	Annual review Aug 1	Revise before next hire
NDA — Standard	NDA	28	—	⚠ 3	—	Monitor at review

NDA scores low individually but drives 3 cross-document conflicts — see consistency matrix below.

CROSS-DOCUMENT CONSISTENCY MATRIX

CLAUSE TOPIC	EXEC VS NDA	ACCT MGR VS NDA	ACCT MGR VS EXEC	DEV VS NDA
Confidentiality period	×	×	✓	~
IP / work-product	×	✓	✓	×
Non-solicitation scope	✓	~	~	✓
Termination formula	N/A	N/A	×	N/A
Governing law	✓	✓	✓	✓
Dispute resolution	✓	✓	✓	~

× Direct conflict ~ Inconsistency ✓ Consistent

MILESTONES & EXPIRIES

- **May 28** — Account Manager probation ends. ESC notice obligations now fully apply.
- **Jun 14** — Executive non-compete expires. Review before departure risk window opens.
- **Aug 1** — Server Contract annual review. Update overtime language before then.

CFO / COO SNAPSHOT

$340K+
Max estimated exposure
Common-law reasonable notice on 2 critical contracts if terminated today.

3 docs
Need legal review
Budget 4–6 hrs employment counsel at $400–450/hr before next hire cycle.

Prompts

- Styling
  - Functionality, audience, color pallet
- Architecture
  - We explicitly told AI the tech stack, directory structure and API functionality
- Criticizing
  - Assigned person of “critical project manager”
  - Used multiple LLM’s to criticize each other's work
- Simplify the PRD for Replit efficiency
- At each stage we gave AI a persona:
  - “you are a graphic designer”
  - “you are a software engineer”
  - “you are a designer”

Product Roadmap

$168 M

TAM – ~177,000 SME AB employers × $79/mo



$46 M

SAM – ~45,000 firms with 10–250 staff, non-union, non-federal

$1.6 M

SOM – ~2,250 accounts @ $59 ARPU, 3-yr at 5% SAM penetration

Pricing Model

Free – $0

2 contracts, watermarked exports

Starter – $29/mo

10 contracts, full dashboard, PDF exports

Pro – $79/mo

Unlimited, 3 seats, cross-doc, leadership report

Consultant – $179/mo

Multi-workspace, white-label PDF, client portfolios

Roadmap

Phase 2



Real product: Stripe, Supabase, CanLII API, OCR

Phase 3



More law: BC ESA, Ontario ESA, multi-jurisdiction

Phase 4



More contracts: contractor, termination, NDAs

Phase 5



Marketplace: AB lawyer directory + referrals

Marketplace flow



Small employer

Uploads contracts, sees risk report, clicks “Find a lawyer”



HireGuard

Matches risk profile to vetted AB lawyers, pre-sends a brief



Alberta lawyer

Pre-triaged client, brief already prepared, referral revenue

“An Alberta employment lawyer charges $400/hr to tell you what HireGuard shows in 30 seconds — and HireGuard can spot the same risk across your other contracts.”



HireGuard

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